The UAE Charter for the Development and Use of Artificial Intelligence

The UAE Charter for the Development and Use of Artificial Intelligence aims to achieve the strategic goals of the UAE Strategy for Artificial Intelligence, reflecting the leadership's vision of transforming the country into a global hub for developing and adopting AI solutions and applications across various fields. The charter also covers principles to enhance awareness in the AI field for an inclusive future and for leveraging AI advancements to guarantee equitable technological access for all segments of society. Additionally, it includes principles for compliance with existing legislation and agreements related to the development and use of AI in the country.

Policy Objectives

1. Ensure the use of artificial intelligence in an ethical and responsible manner.
2. Protect privacy and data security.
3. Balance technological advancement with social values.
4. Encourage innovation and support economic growth.
5. Increase awareness and education about artificial intelligence.
6. Enhance transparency and accountability in its use.
7. Improve the UAE's global standing in technology and innovation.

Priorities & Key Components

1. Strengthening Human-Machine Ties:

- The UAE aims to enhance the harmonious and beneficial relationship between AI and humans, ensuring that all AI developments prioritize human well-being and progress.

2. Safety:

- The UAE places great importance on safety, ensuring that all AI systems comply with the highest safety standards. The country encourages modifying or removing systems that pose risks.

3. Algorithmic Bias:

- The UAE aims to address the challenges posed by AI algorithms regarding algorithmic bias, contributing to a fair and equitable environment for all community members. This promotes responsible development of AI technologies, making them inclusive and accessible to everyone, supporting diversity, and respecting individual differences. It ensures equal technological benefits and improves quality of life without exclusion or discrimination.

4. Data Privacy:

- In line with the UAE's stance on privacy rights, while data is essential for AI development, supporting and promoting innovation in AI, the privacy of community members remains a top priority.

5. Transparency:

- The UAE seeks to create a clear understanding of AI and how systems operate and make decisions, which helps build trust, enhance responsibility, and accountability in the use of these technologies.

6. Human Oversight:

- The Charter emphasizes the irreplaceable value of human judgment and human oversight over AI, aligning with ethical values and social standards to correct any errors or biases that may arise.

7. Governance and Accountability:

- The UAE adopts a responsible and proactive stance, emphasizing the importance of governance and accountability in AI to ensure the technology is used ethically and transparently.

8. Technological Excellence:

- AI should be a beacon of innovation, reflecting the UAE's vision of digital, technological, and scientific excellence. The UAE seeks global leadership by adopting technological excellence in AI to drive innovation, enhance competitiveness, and improve quality of life through innovative and effective solutions to complex challenges, contributing to sustainable progress benefiting society as a whole.

9. Human Commitment:

- Human commitment in AI reflects the spirit of the UAE, essential for ensuring that the development of this technology serves the public good. It focuses on enhancing human well-being and protecting fundamental rights, emphasizing the importance of placing human values at the heart of technological innovation to ensure a positive and lasting impact on society.

10. Peaceful Coexistence with AI:

- Peaceful coexistence with AI is crucial to ensure technology enhances the well-being and progress of our communities without compromising human security or fundamental rights.

11. Promoting AI Awareness for an Inclusive Future:

- It is essential to create an inclusive future that ensures everyone can benefit from AI advancements, guaranteeing equitable access to this technology and its advantages for all segments of society.

12. Commitment to Treaties and Applicable Laws:

- The UAE emphasizes the importance of complying with international treaties and local laws in the development and use of AI. Top of FormBottom of Form

Expected Outcomes

1. Enhance innovation and attract investments, thereby increasing efficiency and productivity.
2. Improve quality of life by enhancing healthcare and educational services, and by increasing awareness and education about artificial intelligence.
3. Utilize artificial intelligence to improve sustainability and protect the environment.
4. Enhance government services and improve their efficiency.
5. Boost the UAE's global standing in innovation and technology, contributing to an improved ranking in global indices.

Personal Data Protection Law

Federal Decree Law No. 45 of 2021 Regarding the Protection of Personal Data, also known as the Personal Data Protection Law constitutes an integrated framework to ensure the confidentiality of information and protect the privacy of individuals in the UAE. It provides a proper governance for data management and protection and defines the rights and duties of all parties concerned.

Provisions of the law

Here are some of the provisions of the law in brief:

1. The provisions of the law apply to the processing of personal data, whether in full or part through electronic systems, inside or outside the country.
2. The law defines the controls for the processing of personal data and the general obligations of companies that have personal data to secure it and maintain its confidentiality and privacy. It prohibits the processing of personal data without the consent of its owner, except for some cases in which the processing is necessary to protect a public interest or to carry out any of the legal procedures and rights.
3. The law gives the owner of the data the right to request for corrections of inaccurate personal data and to restrict or stop the processing of his personal data.
4. It sets out the requirements for the cross-border transfer and sharing of personal data for processing purposes.

The Personal Data Protection Law is the first federal law to be drafted in partnership with major technology companies in the private sector. It came into force on 2 January 2022.

Related links

- Federal Decree Law No. 45 of 2021 Regarding the Protection of Personal Data - (PDF, 350 KB - available in Arabic only).

Data and privacy protection

Other laws related to data protection and privacy include:

Consumer protection law

The Federal Law No. 15 of 2020 on Consumer Protection protects all consumer rights, including the data of the consumers and prohibits suppliers from using it for marketing. Also, there is Data Protection Law, DIFC Law No 5 of 2020.

Law about the use of ICT in the health sector

Federal Law No. 2 of 2019 Concerning the Use of Information and Communication Technology (ICT) in Health Fields regulates the use of information and communication technology (ICT) in the health care sector in the UAE, including its free zones.

Law on combatting rumours and cybercrimes

Federal Decree Law No. 34 of 2021 on Combatting Rumours and Cybercrimes provides a comprehensive legal framework to address the concerns relating to the misuse and abuse of online technologies. It aims to enhance the level of protection from online crimes committed through the use of information technology, networks and platforms.

Internet Access Management (IAM) policy

Telecommunications and Digital Government Regulatory Authority (TDRA) implements the Internet Access Management (IAM) policy in the UAE, in coordination with National Media Council and Etisalat and Du, the licensed internet service providers in the UAE. Under this policy, online content that is used for impersonation, fraud and phishing and/or invades privacy can be reported to Etisalat and Du to be taken down.

Read more about UAE laws and resolutions concerning activities conducted online.

Electronic Transactions and Trust Services law

The law regulates the validity of electronic documents and boosts the legal value of digital signature and the level of its security. It provides provisions for eTransactions, the way eDocuments should be stored and saved, and sent and received to be valid. It also sets licensing requirements for trust services providers who are duly licensed to create, validate and preserve eSignatures, eSeals and digital certification.

The UAE's Constitution

Article 31 of the UAE's Constitution provides for the freedom of communication by means of post, telegraph or other means of communication and guarantees their confidentiality in accordance with the law.

Protection of copyrights, patents and trade marks

Find out laws that ensure protection of copyrights, patents and trademarks.

Protection of credit information

Read about the Federal Law No. 6 of 2010 on Credit Information and its amendments (Arabic only).

Dubai Data law

The government of Dubai passed the Dubai Data law. One of its aim is data protection and privacy of the individual.

Read Citizens' right to access government information.

UAE Data Office

The UAE Data Office will act as the federal data regulator in the UAE. The office which is affiliated with the UAE Cabinet will be responsible for:

- preparing policies and legislations related to data protection
- proposing and approving the standards for monitoring Personal Data Protection Law
- preparing systems for complaints and grievances related to data
- issuing guidelines and instructions for the implementation of the law.

Related links

- UAE Federal Decree Law No. 44 of 2021 on the establishment of the UAE Data Office.

The National Cyber Security Policy for Artificial Intelligence

The National Artificial Intelligence Security Policy defines minimum security requirements for adoption of AI in the UAE. It establishes governance, infrastructure, algorithm protection, operational safety, threat monitoring, and performance evaluation to manage emerging AI risks.

In the evolving landscape of artificial intelligence (AI) technology, the proliferation and integration of AI systems have ushered in a new era of innovation and transformation across industries. As AI-driven applications become embedded in critical functions and decision-making processes, the need to ensure the security of AI systems has gained unprecedented prominence. With the intricate interplay of data, algorithms, and autonomous decision-making that AI entails, the need to fortify these systems against potential vulnerabilities and unauthorised access has become paramount. In the face of

escalating cybersecurity threats and the potential consequences of AI-related breaches, safeguarding the confidentiality, ethicality, and integrity of AI systems is not only a necessity but a fundamental responsibility.

The Cyber Security Council has established this policy to enhance cyber security in artificial intelligence, aligned with the UAE's national priority to be a global leader in cyber security; and enhance the security posture of organisations and individuals within the UAE using artificial intelligence.

Governance

Requirements to establish a robust governance framework for AI/ML systems, ensuring their secure design, development, and operation through comprehensive, enforceable policies and procedures. It focuses on identifying, assessing, and mitigating unique risks, managing supply chain risks, controlling system changes, and ensuring compliance with privacy regulations.

Infrastructure & Application Security

Requirements for maintaining an accurate inventory of AI/ML assets, securing system configurations, applying timely security patches, remediating vulnerabilities, and ensuring the secure development, testing, and maintenance of AI/ML applications. It also emphasizes the importance of robust network security controls to protect system confidentiality, integrity, and availability.

Algorithm Security

Requirements to integrate security into the design and development of AI/ML models from the earliest stages, maintaining model security, protecting inference processes, enforcing access controls for training data, and ensuring data protection at rest and in motion.

Operational Safety

Requirements to tailor security measures based on the distinct applications of AI/ML systems, ensuring human oversight in critical decision-making, establishing protocols for system resilience, and ensuring continuity and reliability through comprehensive testing and validation.

Adversarial AI Attacks

Requirements to understand and anticipate potential AI/ML attacks, fostering a proactive security approach that includes education, awareness, and comprehensive defense techniques, continuous monitoring, testing, and robust incident response.

AI Monitoring & Response

Requirements to establish an effective AI/ML security analytics framework for real-time threat detection and predictive insights. It also focuses on implementing an automated response framework

for AI/ML security incidents, ensuring efficient incident reporting and management, and developing a comprehensive digital forensics framework tailored to AI/ML security breaches.

Read the full policy here (PDF, 2.14 MB).

Dimensions of the UAE Digital Government Strategy 2025

The UAE's National Digital Government Strategy is drafted on eight dimensions. The dimensions were aimed to leverage The OECD Digital Government Policy Framework and were tailored to fit the UAE's developmental plan in the post pandemic era. The eight dimensions are:

1. Leaving no one behind (Inclusive by default)
2. Resilient
3. Fit for the digital age
4. User-driven
5. Digital by design
6. Data-driven
7. Open by default
8. Proactiveness.

Below is a brief description of the dimensions.

Leaving no one behind (Inclusive by default)

This can be achieved by:

1. Adopting open and inclusive processes, accessibility, transparency and accountability among the main goals of UAE digital government strategies and
2. Ensuring inclusiveness and overcoming any digital divides that might arise with special focus on elders, people with determination, women, children and other vulnerable groups.

Resilient

This involves leveraging the emerging technologies to build capabilities in anticipation of disasters and crises to be able to respond to them proactively, and adopting more resilient government operations and core capabilities.

Fit for the digital age

This involves promoting cross-sectoral and inter-ministerial co-ordination and collaboration, setting national priorities and engaging relevant stakeholders in pursuing the UAE's digital agenda.

User-driven

This dimension recommends governments to be more user-driven, highlighting the notion of engagement by default. It advises keeping people' needs and convenience at the centre of shaping

processes, services and policies and adopting inclusive mechanisms.

Digital by design

This dimension is about establishing clear organisational leadership along with effective co-ordination and enforcement mechanisms to ensure digital by default practices. All policy processes must be embedded with 'digital' as a mandatory, by design, transformative element. Furthermore, ongoing experimentation plays a vital role in this dimension by facilitating the creation of controlled and flexible testing environments. These environments allow regulators, the private sector, innovators, and business leaders to collaborate and co-create legislation that aligns with the rapid pace of innovation. Read about the regulatory sandboxes in the UAE.

Data-driven

Under this dimension, a digital government governs data as a key strategic asset in generating public value through applying it in the planning, delivering and monitoring of public policies, and adopts rules and ethical principles for their trustworthy and safe reuse.

Open by default

Open by default means making government data and policy-making processes (including algorithms) available for the public to engage with.

Proactiveness

This dimension is about the ability of governments and civil servants to anticipate people's needs and respond to them rapidly enough, so that users do not have to engage with the cumbersome process of data and service delivery. By utilizing a seamless Single Sign-On system with the UAE National Digital ID – UAE PASS and adopting a life cycle approach and once only policy, the need for users to apply for services or submit supporting documents is eliminated. Instead, users receive automatic notifications of tailored proactive services. This simplifies service delivery and improves the user experience by removing unnecessary bureaucratic obstacles.

Objectives and priorities

The main objective of the UAE digital strategy is to create a broad cross-sectoral government commitment and buy-in for embedding the digital aspects into overall government strategies. This is crucial to ensure that the UAE Government is digital by design and that all capacities, structures and opportunities are integrated on a national level and aligned with the UAE's strategic digital government vision. The following are the objectives and priorities of the strategy:

1. providing a world-class digital infrastructure
2. providing a unified digital platform and common digital enablers
3. enable integrated, easy and fast digital services designed based on the needs of customers
4. raising the level of digital capabilities and skills

5. legislation readiness to ensure a smooth and comprehensive digital transformation
6. raising the efficiency of government work.

The UAE Digital Government roadmap comprises six main pillars that encompass 64 national digital enablers.

3: Unified Digital Platform

19: Shared Digital Enablers

20: Digital Infrastructure & Services

3: Digital Engagement

7: Digital Capacity

11: Laws, Policies & Standards

Strategic KPIs

Main indicator	Sub indicator	Target by 2025
Public satisfaction	Citizen satisfaction towards digital government Services	90% (Very satisfied)
Businesses satisfaction towards digital government services		
Complete digital transformation	Percentage of services listed on the unified digital platform	90%
Percentage of services digitised (end-to-end)	100%	
Services that require personal verification offer a digital option	100%	
Services that require a manual signature offer a digital option	100%	
Digital capabilities	Number of workforce in the federal government trained on digital	100%

	government capabilities and standards	
Number of federal government workforce that has basic digital knowledge	100%	
The number of workforce in the federal government trained in modern technologies (such as blockchain, artificial intelligence, bot processing, etc.)	10%	
Digital adoption	Percentage of transactions completed digitally end to end	85%

Maturity model

The UAE Digital Government Strategy aims to assess the UAE government organisations on both federal and local levels against a maturity model which will help create clarity about the UAE digital government capability and to inform investments in new capabilities. The maturity model comprises eight main dimensions as follows:

Leadership

Leaders are the stewards of digital transformation efforts. They must engage, motivate, build commitment, and mobilise resources for the successful implementation of a digital strategy.

Strategy

Strategic plans help to execute the transformation agenda. A digital transformation strategy contains the actions to be taken to pursue the digital transformation goals.

Governance

Good governance must be aligned with strategic goals, as well as legal frameworks.

Legal

The legislation, administrative regulations, guidelines and standards that a department or agency must comply with in transforming digital services.

Technology

Emerging technologies that directly and indirectly contribute to the delivery of programs and services through digital platforms.

Cybersecurity

Cybersecurity is important for digital government. With more services being made available online, there is a need to increase security mechanisms to ensure protections to sensitive and private citizen information.

Specific technologies and new trends

Emergent technologies and new trends bring promising opportunities for governments to transform their digital services and leapfrog in terms of citizen satisfaction.

Ministry/Agency specific

These are items specific to each ministry/authority and they reflect some primary functions as well as the most important information and services provided digitally.

Each dimension has a set of sub-dimensions that guide enabling actions that each government entity might take to increase their maturity along each dimension. Each sub-dimension has a set of specific items to be used by each UAE government entity to determine their level of maturity for each sub-dimension and dimension.

The five levels of maturity range from Level 1 representing a very low level of maturity to level 5 representing a very high level of maturity. The assessment responses provide an outline for a roadmap for a successful digital government transformation.

Maturity Level	**Sub Indicator**
1	Very low level of maturity
2	Low level of maturity
3	Average level of maturity
4	High level of maturity
5	Very high level of maturity

The objective is 100 per cent - very high level of maturity for all UAE government entities on both federal and local levels by 2025.

Commitment to achieving the Sustainable Development Goals 2030

The National Digital Government Strategy is committed to achieving the United Nations' Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) 2030. While the strategy aims to bridge digital divide, it brings the UAE closer to achieving the SDG of reducing inequality. In addition, it aims to maintain the UAE as a safe, stable and peaceful society. The UAE's justice system is one of the most stable and developed. It has various laws to maintain justice and safety of the Emiratis and the various communities living there, thereby, aiding in achieving the SDG of peace, justice and strong institutions.

Alignment with the national development strategies

The National Digital Government Strategy is aligned with following national strategies:

We the UAE 2031' vision

Unified Digital Platform Policy

The UAE Strategy for Government Services

National Policy for Quality of Digital Life

Future Foresight Strategy

UAE Centennial 2071

UAE Strategy for Artificial Intelligence

Fourth Industrial Revolution (4IR) Strategy

Digital Customer and Digital Government Service Policy

Gamification

National Strategy for Advanced Innovation

Open Government Data laws, policies, strategies, guidelines

The National Standard For Business Continuity Management System

Digital Participation Strategy

- 'We the UAE 2031' vision – it represents a national plan through which the UAE will continue its development path for the next 10 years, with focus on social, economic, investment and development aspects. The plan seeks to enhance the position of the UAE as a global partner and an attractive and influential economic hub. It aims to highlight the successful economic model of the UAE and the opportunities it provides to all global partners
- Unified Digital Platform Policy – it aims to provide all government services from one unified platform, employing digital government enablers to integrate and connect digital systems of the

UAE federal government and raising efficiency in providing digital services

- The UAE Strategy for Government Services - it aims to provide 90 per cent of the public services through a single digital platform, design 100 per cent proactive digital services, design 100 per cent services in partnership with all sectors of the community and ensure that, by 2023, all government services will be accessible from anywhere and at any time

- National Policy for Quality of Digital Life – it aims to build the capacities of members of the community and enable them to use the internet in a responsible manner, consolidate positive digital values and behaviours, guide the community to use positive content and protect users from the risks of dealing with suspicious parties

- Future Foresight Strategy - it aims to make foresighting the future a part of the strategic planning in the government and launch studies and scenarios to forecast the future of all priority sectors and draft plans and policies based on that

- UAE Centennial 2071 – it is a full-vision plan that extends for 5 decades after 2021 and forms a roadmap for future government work. A future-focused government is one of the four pillars of Centennial 2071.

- UAE Strategy for Artificial Intelligence – it aims to:

    - achieve the objectives of UAE Centennial 2071
    - boost government performance at all levels
    - use an integrated smart digital system that can overcome challenges and provide quick efficient solutions
    - make the UAE the first in the field of AI investments in various sectors
    - create new vital market with high economic value.

- Fourth Industrial Revolution (4IR) Strategy – it aims to make the UAE, a leading global hub and an open lab for the Fourth Industrial Revolution's applications.

- Digital Customer and Digital Government Service Policy – it aims to:

    - enhance the UAE Government's approach of providing proactive digital services on a priority
    - improve user experience in getting digital government services
    - raise government efficiency in providing services
    - enable integration and connection of digital systems of federal government entities
    - raise trust in digital government services.

- Gamification – Launched on KidX, a digital platform for children, gamification aims to increase children's participation in understanding the role of the government and improving them.

- National Strategy for Advanced Innovation - aims to:

    - establish a national platform for innovation, communication and learning

- encourage the community to take the spirit of initiative
- try out new models of government for serving society
- test advanced economic patterns and lay the groundwork to create new sectors
- achieve scientific breakthroughs that focus on the welfare of people
- collaborate with leading international institutions and companies specialised in the field of innovation.

- Open Government Data laws, policies, strategies, guidelines – aim to:
  - Enhancing Transparency and Accountability by providing citizens and businesses with access to government data.
  - Encouraging Innovation by making government data available to the public, open data policies in the UAE can encourage innovation by enabling entrepreneurs and developers to create new products and services that benefit society.
  - Promoting Collaboration by providing a common platform for sharing and accessing data.
  - Increasing Efficiency by reducing the time and resources required to collect and analyze data, and by enabling data sharing and reuse across government entities.

- The National Standard For Business Continuity Management System - is for organizations to implement and maintain an effective management system that provides the capability to continue operations during disruptions. It provides a framework for developing and implementing a business continuity management (BCM) program that can help organizations minimize the impact of disruptions on their operations and services and ensure their timely recovery. The standards cover a range of areas, including risk assessment, business impact analysis, crisis management, business continuity planning, communication, and training and awareness.

  Implementation of the Standard will enable UAE government and private sector entities to:

  - Protect against and reduce the likelihood or impact of disruptions.
  - Prepare for, respond to, and recover from disruptions.
  - Effective implementation across UAE government entities and their private-sector partners will also enhance national stability.

- Digital Participation Strategy - It aims to foster public participation in governance by building a consultative ecosystem where the people are able to share their ideas, thoughts and recommendations with government entities. The entire ecosystem rests on the principles of inclusion, ensuring a deeper involvement of all segments of society equally in charting the UAE's future. Read more about key objectives and strategic capabilities of the Digital Participation Strategy.

Alignment with local eGovernment development strategies

The National Digital Government Strategy is aligned with the strategies of the local governments. Abu Dhabi Digital Transformation Strategy aims to make the emirate a leading proponent and key driver of

its digital future. Abu Dhabi Digital Authority's top priorities are focused on government services and solutions, data and applied technologies, governance and ecosystem enablement.

Meanwhile, Smart Dubai 2021 Strategy has six strategic objectives. They are:

1. smart liveable and resilient city - to achieve full ICT enablement of critical infrastructure and resources to boost efficiency, availability, and resilience
2. globally competitive economy powered by disruptive technologies - to leverage ICT innovations as means to digitally transform strategic economic sectors and pioneer new rules of economic development and engagement
3. interconnected society with easily accessible social services - to embrace technology to streamline social, cultural, education, and healthcare experiences in the emirate and facilitate inclusive and effective participation of stakeholders in designing city experiences
4. smooth transport driven by autonomous and shared mobility solutions - to pioneer smart innovative mobility solutions for a seamless and safe transportation experience in the emirate
5. clean environment enabled by cutting-edge ICT innovations - to digitally transform utilities, manufacturing, transportation, and waste treatment sectors to reduce the emirate's carbon footprint for a cleaner, healthier environment
6. digital, lean connected government - to be a government with providing all eligible public services through digital channels.

Smart Dubai 2021 Strategy is supported by:

1. Dubai Autonomous Transportation Strategy
2. Dubai 3D Printing Strategy
3. Dubai Data Strategy
4. Dubai Cyber Security Strategy
5. Dubai Blockchain Strategy
6. Dubai Internet of Things Strategy
7. Dubai Paperless Strategy
8. Dubai eCommerce strategy.

Ajman Digital Masterplan 2017-2022 provides a roadmap for a comprehensive digital transformation of Ajman Government services over five years. The five strategic goals of the plan are to:

- achieve a 100 per cent digital transformation of government services by the end of 2018
- achieve a digital transformation of joint government services by the end of 2018
- adopt 80 per cent of digital services by 2021
- complete digital transformation of 30 priority government services every 100 days
- raise financial efficiency of government services by at least 20 per cent by the end of 2021.

Umm Al Quwain Vision 2021 focuses on providing high-quality living standards for a cohesive society. One of the five main pillars of the Vision is an innovative government. Government of Umm Al Quwain aims to implement comprehensive structural development through programmes and initiatives which

support customers' happiness and satisfaction by offering excellent comprehensive services and accelerating transformation towards eGovernment.

Once only policy

Under the 'Once only' policy, users or consumers of Abu Dhabi Government's services will be relieved from submitting supporting documents every time they apply for a service. To benefit from this policy, users will submit their documents only once via the portal of Abu Dhabi Government. This data will be saved and shared with government entities and companies via the Abu Dhabi Connect Platform, which is the only digital platform to provide and share digital information with government entities and companies.

The 'Once only' policy will facilitate transactions by:

- reducing the number of documents required for each transaction
- easing procedures of services
- ensuring seamless use of data in a secure way.

Once only is the first policy of its kind in the region to enhance government's digital transformation.